A-A-54222
20 July 1990

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

WATER BATH, ELECTRIC (Microtome Tissue Specimen Section Mounting)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers a tissue float bath for softening embedded tissue specimens.

Salient Characteristics:

Shall be a constant temperature water bath with a variable temperature setting, suitable for use as a tissue float bath for softening embedded tissue specimens before being affixed to microscope slides.

Shall be suitable for use on 120 volt, 50/60 Hz, AC supply lines.

Shall have a double-walled round-basin type of construction, with a nominal 2 inch wide ledge between the exterior and interior walls. The ledge shall provide a warming area for the slides, and shall slant inward toward the working chamber to eliminate drippage on the work bench. Suitable insulation shall be included between the outer housing and working chamber to conserve heat and permit handling when the working chamber is in a heated condition. The exterior surface shall be cool to a user's touch when the working chamber is in a heated condition.

The working chamber shall have nominal dimensions (inches) of 8-1/2 diameter by 2-1/2 deep, and shall have at least a 2 3 liter capacity.

The bath temperature shall be controlled by an adjustable infinite heat controller with reference dial markings. The dial adjustments shall permit operation from slightly above ambient to 70 degrees Centigrade (C) with a uniformity of plus or minus 1 degree (C) for a preset temperature. The bath temperature shall be monitored by a partial-immersion glass thermometer (to be supplied with the water bath) which shall be inserted in the water bath and held in place by a suitable thermometer holder. The thermometer shall be easily removable from the thermometer holder.

AMSC N/A FSC 6640

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The working chamber shall be fabricated of anodized aluminum that is finished with a water resistant and matte black color to insure a high visibility of the floating, presectioned and translucent tissues. The outer housing shall be fabricated of corrosion-resistant steel, or of aluminum with a black anodized finish.

The water bath shall include the following electrical controls:

1. An on-off switch to control all electrical power to the water bath.
2. A red pilot light to indicate when heater element(s) are energized.
3. A temperature selector with reference dial settings.

The water bath shall be fitted with a minimum five foot overall length three-wire power cord that terminates with a three-blade male grounding plug that is suitable for use with receptacles shown in ANSI Standard C73 11 or shown in Configuration No. 5-15 of NEMA Standard WD 6-88

The power rating for the water bath shall not exceed 300 watts.

Workmanship. The water bath shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One water bath, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request.

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at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Inspections and testing. Inspections and testing shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice. Sampling for the inspections and testing shall be in accordance with commercial practice. In addition, each water bath shall be tested to demonstrate its capability for proper operation.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances and regulations.

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Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent that is specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

AMERICAN NATIONAL STANDARDS INSTITUTE (ANSI)

C73.11 Plugs and Receptacles - General Purpose 125 Volts, 15 Amperes, 2 Pole, 3 Wire Grounding Type, Dimensions of

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American National Standards Institute, 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018)

NATIONAL ELECTRICAL MANUFACTURERS ASSOCIATION NEMA)

WD 6-88 Wiring Devices - Dimensional Requirements (Revision and Redesignation of ANSI C73-73)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Electrical Manufacturers Association, 2101 L Street, NW Suite 300, Washington, DC 20037)

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

NSN 6640-00-107-1980

NSN 6640-01-177-2653

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.)

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project Number: 6640-1631

Location ENABLE/WATERCID/31

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3 and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I. RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER: A-A-54222	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD): 20 July 1991

3. DOCUMENT TITLE: WATER BATH, ELECTRIC (Microtome Tissue Specimen Section Mounting

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (*Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.*)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)
	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON
Defense Personnel Support Center	(215)737-2870	444-2870
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) ATTN: DPSC-MSTE 2800 S. 20th Street Philadelphia, PA 19101	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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